

scripts/check-emulator-runner-tag.sh — User Guide

Last verified: 2026-06-02 (anti-forgetting enforcement cycle) **Inheritance:** §6.X clause (c) (Container-Submodule Emulator Wiring Mandate); HelixConstitution §11.4.18 (script docs) **Classification:** universal

Overview

Makes §6.X enforcement clause (c) mechanical at the check-constitution.sh / pre-push layer: every **NEW** emulator/Challenge attestation evidence file that records emulator execution **MUST** declare runner: containers-submodule (or runner=containers-submodule). A new evidence file that records an emulator run with a raw/host-direct runner tag — or NO runner tag — FAILS.

Previously clause (c) was paper-only ("rows lacking this declaration are rejected by scripts/tag.sh"). This scanner closes the anti-forgetting gap on the NEXT bad file at pre-push time.

Scope — going-forward, not retroactive

The gate flags only evidence files that are **newly added relative to git HEAD** (staged additions under .lava-ci-evidence/ + untracked files there). Pre-existing committed evidence is grandfathered:

- many historical files predate §6.X (added 2026-05-13); and
- several document the §6.X-RESOLVED macOS host-direct + HVF gate path (a Linux container cannot reach HVF//dev/kvm, so host-direct+HVF IS the macOS gate runner per the §6.X 67th-cycle resolution).

Retroactively failing committed history is not the job (and the task constraint forbids touching real evidence). Enforcing the tag on the next file is.

"Records emulator execution" heuristic

A file is in scope when it mentions any of (case-insensitive):
adb_devices_state, boot_seconds, connectedAndroidTest,
connectedDebugAndroidTest, emulator-matrix. Files without these markers
(design docs, host-stability incidents, bluff-hunt logs) are not flagged.

Accepted runner tag

runner: containers-submodule OR runner=containers-submodule, with
optional surrounding quotes/whitespace (matches both JSON and key=value
evidence forms).

Overrides

Variable	Effect
LAVA_EMULATOR_EVIDENCE_FILES	Newline-separated explicit file list to scan (hermetic-test injection; bypasses git-new-file detection).
LAVA_EMULATOR_RUNNER_STRICT=0	Advisory mode — exit 0 even on violation.

Usage

```
bash scripts/check-emulator-runner-tag.sh           # going-  
forward, strict (default)  
LAVA_EMULATOR_RUNNER_STRICT=0 bash scripts/check-emulator-runner-  
tag.sh      # advisory
```

Invoked automatically as §6.X(6) from scripts/check-constitution.sh.

Hermetic test

tests/check-constitution/test_emulator_runner_tag.sh — the §6.A
paired falsifiability proof: a fixture with a non-containers/absent runner tag
FAILS (exit 1); the same fixture with runner: containers-submodule
PASSES (exit 0); plus equals-form, non-emulator no-false-positive,
advisory-mode, and real-tree cases. Run:

```
bash tests/check-constitution/test_emulator_runner_tag.sh
```